



FROM THE FOUNDER'S DESK

Why I Founded [Youth for Pelindaba \(Y4Pel\)](#)
A personal reflection by [Lopuyo Paulo Lokwawi](#)

When I first learned about the Treaty of Pelindaba, I was surprised by how little many young Africans knew about one of our continent's greatest commitments to peace and security. Although Africa established a Nuclear-Weapon-Free Zone decades ago, awareness of the treaty remains limited among young people, despite its significance for our collective future.

As a Physicist, Radiation Health and Youth Advocate, I have had the privilege of engaging with national and international initiatives, including the [Nuclear Society of Kenya](#), United Nations Office for Disarmament Affairs ([UNODA](#)) Youth Leader Fund for a World Without Nuclear Weapons, and the [Hiroshima-ICAN Academy](#). These experiences introduced me to inspiring young leaders from around the world while revealing an important gap: Africa lacked a dedicated youth platform focused on advancing the vision of the Treaty of Pelindaba.

That realization led to the founding of [Youth for Pelindaba \(Y4Pel\)](#).

| “Africa's nuclear future should be shaped not only by
| governments, but also by informed, empowered African
| youth.” — Lopuyo Paulo Lokwawi

Y4Pel is a pan-African, youth-led initiative committed to empowering young Africans through education, dialogue, research, advocacy, leadership, and partnerships that promote nuclear disarmament, radiation safety, and the peaceful uses of nuclear science and technology.

Our vision is ambitious yet achievable: to see every African country represented by informed and active young people working together for a peaceful, secure, and nuclear-weapon-free Africa.

Together, we can transform the ideals of the Treaty of Pelindaba into action.

Lopuyo Paulo Lokwawi
Founder, Youth for Pelindaba (Y4Pel)

Peace. Science. Leadership.